



This large root can grow up to 12 in (30 cm) long and is eaten as a winter food by people and cattle.

Taro

Rutabaga

Radish

This underground stem is an important food in tropical regions of Africa and Asia.

Colorful varieties are grown for their high vitamin content.

Potato

These peppery roots are eaten raw in salads

Carrot

This tropical root is used to produce flour and can also be eaten as a vegetable.

Cassava

The knobby tubers become sweeter when left in the sun.

Daikon

Long white roots grow up to 23 1/2 in (60 cm) long and are a popular food in Asia.

Oca

These crunchy roots taste sweet and come in a variety of colors.

horizontally, called rhizomes. **Potatoes** and **ocas** are tubers made from swollen stems and have spots called eyes from which new shoots can grow. Many root vegetables are vital food sources. **Cassava**, for example, can be grown in poor, dry soils and is a staple food in many parts of Africa. The **dandelion** is perhaps best known for its yellow flowers, but its roots can be used to make tea, which is believed to have medicinal properties.